

**HECKLER AND KOCH G3A3, 1964**

- 1945** Occupying French forces dismantle the Mauser weapons factory at Oberndorf, Germany.
- 1949** Heckler and Koch begins to manufacture items for non-military use, such as components for domestic appliances and bicycles.
- 1959** The contract for the new infantry rifle for the West German army is awarded to the company. The G3 follows, and later, the G3A3 (see p.243).

**HECKLER AND KOCH MP5A5, 1966**

- 1966** The MP5 is developed. The MP5A5 (see p.292) follows.
- 1968** The HK33 assault rifle is launched. It is a 5.56mm weapon intended for the export market.
- 1981** The G41 rifle (see p.243), originally designed as a replacement for the HK33, is introduced.
- 1990** The company's long-running project to develop the G11 assault rifle, with high-velocity caseless

**HECKLER AND KOCH G41, 1981**

- ammunition, is canceled due to political changes surrounding Germany's reunification.
- 1991** The British company Royal Ordnance purchases Heckler and Koch.
- 2002** Heckler and Koch is sold to private investors and receives substantial orders for the British SA80 assault rifle (see p.251) and other firearms.

gun, which, like the G3, is a modular design so that the user can adapt it with ease; it has spawned many variants. The MP5 has been bought by military and law-enforcement customers all over the world and is one of the most ubiquitous submachine-guns.

The company also worked with materials which were new and unusual for firearms, such as polymers. While these materials had

been used for nonstructural parts such as grips, Heckler and Koch (as well as companies such as Glock) pioneered their use for gun frames, making huge weight savings, and once the precision molds for the parts had been made, savings in manufacturing costs, too. Polygonal rifling is another technology in which Heckler and Koch have expertise. This old idea had fallen out of favor, but

Heckler and Koch applied it to modern weapons, replacing the traditional grooved barrel with a rounded polygonal internal surface to give a better gas seal around the projectile. Heckler and Koch have successfully tethered these technological ideas to the development of versatile families of weapons, making them one of the leading firearms manufacturers of the 21st century.



► MP5 IN USE

Members of the US Special Operations Response Team (SORT), who operate in prisons and are specialists in handling tense and dangerous situations among the inmates, were frequent users of the MP5 between 2000 and 2010.